



TRUSTFORCE ADVISORS RESOURCE GUIDE

Conservatorship Checklist

A Practical Guide for Organizing Records, Assets, Court Duties, and Ongoing Responsibilities

Important disclaimer: TrustForce Advisors provides fiduciary support services and does not provide legal advice unless otherwise stated by a licensed attorney. These resources are for general educational and organizational purposes only. Laws, court requirements, fiduciary duties, and reporting rules may vary by state, court, agency, and case type. Always consult the court, your attorney, or a licensed professional regarding your specific situation.

Purpose: This checklist is designed to help conservators stay organized, protect the protected person's assets, maintain proper records, and prepare for court reporting responsibilities. A conservator may be responsible for managing money, property, benefits, bills, insurance, financial records, and court-required accountings. Good organization from the beginning can help prevent confusion, missed deadlines, family disputes, and court concerns.

Section 1: First Steps After Appointment

Court Authority Documents

Collect and safely store

- Certified Order Appointing Conservator
- Letters of Conservatorship
- Bond paperwork, if required
- Court instructions or local rules

- Case number and court contact information
- Attorney contact information
- Copies of any restrictions on your authority

Immediate Action Checklist

- ☐ Review the court order carefully
- ☐ Confirm what powers you do and do not have
- ☐ Calendar all reporting deadlines
- ☐ Create a conservatorship binder or digital file
- ☐ Notify key financial institutions
- ☐ Identify immediate bills and urgent expenses
- ☐ Secure checkbooks, debit cards, financial records, mail, and important documents

Section 2: Create a Fiduciary File

Every conservatorship should have an organized recordkeeping system.

Recommended File Sections

1. Court Documents
2. Attorney Communications
3. Bank Accounts
4. Income and Benefits
5. Bills and Expenses
6. Real Estate
7. Vehicles
8. Insurance
9. Taxes
10. Receipts
11. Medical and Care Expenses
12. Court Accountings
13. Family Communications
14. Emergency Contacts

Section 3: Financial Accounts Checklist

Identify and document all financial accounts.

Bank Accounts

- ☐ Checking accounts
- ☐ Savings accounts
- ☐ Money market accounts
- ☐ Certificates of deposit

- ☐ Joint accounts
- ☐ Online banking accounts
- ☐ Prepaid cards
- ☐ Cash on hand

Investment and Retirement Accounts

- ☐ Brokerage accounts
- ☐ IRAs
- ☐ 401(k)s
- ☐ 403(b)s
- ☐ Pensions
- ☐ Annuities
- ☐ Stocks and bonds
- ☐ Mutual funds
- ☐ Cryptocurrency or digital assets, if known

Benefits and Income

- ☐ Social Security
- ☐ SSI
- ☐ SSDI
- ☐ VA benefits
- ☐ Pension income
- ☐ Rental income
- ☐ Employment income
- ☐ Oil, gas, mineral, or royalty income
- ☐ Trust distributions
- ☐ Court settlements

Section 4: Property Inventory

A conservator should create a clear inventory of assets.

Real Estate

Document

- Property address
- Ownership status
- Mortgage balance
- Property taxes
- Insurance coverage

- Estimated value
- Occupancy status
- Repairs needed

Vehicles

Document

- Year, make, and model
- VIN
- Title location
- Insurance
- Loan balance
- Condition
- Current driver or storage location

Personal Property

Include

- Jewelry
- Furniture
- Electronics
- Collectibles
- Firearms, if applicable
- Family heirlooms
- Tools and equipment
- Business equipment

Business Interests

Document

- Business name
- Ownership percentage
- Tax records
- Bank accounts
- Income
- Debts
- Operating agreements
- Licenses

Section 5: Monthly Conservator Duties

Each month, the conservator should complete a financial review.

Monthly Checklist

- ☐ Review bank statements
- ☐ Pay approved bills
- ☐ Track all income
- ☐ Track all expenses
- ☐ Save receipts
- ☐ Update ledger
- ☐ Reconcile accounts
- ☐ Review insurance payments
- ☐ Monitor benefits
- ☐ Document unusual transactions
- ☐ Check for fraud or unauthorized charges
- ☐ Confirm care needs are being met

Section 6: Annual Conservator Duties

Annual duties may vary by court order, but often include

- ☐ Prepare court accounting
- ☐ Gather all bank statements
- ☐ Gather receipts and invoices
- ☐ Update asset inventory
- ☐ Review insurance policies
- ☐ Review tax obligations
- ☐ Confirm property taxes are paid
- ☐ Review benefits eligibility
- ☐ Review budget
- ☐ Meet with attorney or accountant, if needed

Section 7: Emergency Information

Maintain one emergency sheet with

- Protected person's full legal name
- Date of birth
- Address
- Court case number
- Conservator contact
- Attorney contact
- Doctor contact
- Pharmacy

- Insurance information
- Bank contact
- Funeral or burial instructions, if known
- Emergency family contacts

Section 8: Common Conservator Mistakes to Avoid

- Mixing personal funds with conservatorship funds
- Paying yourself without court approval
- Failing to keep receipts
- Missing court deadlines
- Making large gifts without authority
- Selling property without approval, if required
- Ignoring family communication
- Failing to document decisions
- Using cash without receipts
- Waiting until the accounting deadline to organize records

Final Conservator Monthly Checklist

- ☐ Bills paid
- ☐ Income deposited
- ☐ Bank reconciled
- ☐ Receipts filed
- ☐ Ledger updated
- ☐ Court deadlines reviewed
- ☐ Client needs assessed
- ☐ Benefits monitored
- ☐ Property secured
- ☐ Attorney contacted if issues arise

Need Help Managing Fiduciary Responsibilities?

TrustForce Advisors provides professional support for conservators, guardians, trustees, veteran fiduciaries, families and caregivers, attorneys, and professionals.

Schedule a consultation today.

(629) 258-7878 | Hello@TheTrustForce.com | [TheTrustForce.com](https://www.TheTrustForce.com)